Salma Lemkhente

PhD Candidate in Management Sciences
ESADE Business School, Ramon Llull University

salma.lemkhente@alumni.esade.edu
salma-lemkhente.github.io
LinkedIn salma-lemkhente
ORCID 0009-0003-9551-7829
GitHub salma-lemkhente
Barcelona, Spain

Education

PhD in Management Sciences — 2022 – July 2027 (expected)
ESADE Business School, Ramon Llull University — *Barcelona, Spain*
Group for Research in Economics and Finance (GREF)
Dissertation: *Essays on Intangible Investment, Sustainability Capability, and Corporate Innovation*
Advisors: Carolina Villegas-Sanchez and Ariadna Dumitrescu

Affiliate Visiting Scholar — January – December 2025
McDonough School of Business, Georgetown University — *Washington, D.C., USA*

MRes in Management Sciences, Finance Track — 2021 – 2022
ESADE Business School, Ramon Llull University — *Barcelona, Spain*
Final grade: Excellent. Thesis: *Assessing Intangible Capital Measurement Models in Digital vs. Non-Digital Companies*

Dual MSc in Financial Management — 2015 – 2017
Technical University of Catalonia (UPC) and Toulouse Business School — *Barcelona, Spain*

BSc in Business Administration — 2011 – 2015
Toulouse Business School, Programme Grande École — *Toulouse, France*
Preceded by Classes Préparatoires EC (scientific option), Lycée Henri Poincaré, Nancy, 2011–2014

Research Interests

Corporate finance, intangible capital, innovation and competition, sustainable finance, labor and job-postings data

Job Market Paper

What Firms Build: Capability Investment in Hiring and Its Value
Solo-authored

[FILL: abstract, at most 150 words, once the paper is final]

Presentations: EFMA Doctoral Consortium, Kristiansand, 2026 (earlier version)

Working Papers

Do Firms Innovate When the Rivals They Watch Consolidate?
with Carolina Villegas-Sanchez

[FILL: abstract, at most 100 words]

Presentations: FMA Doctoral Consortium, Tampa, 2026

Work in Progress

Dynamic Innovation Responses to Market Structure Change: A Theoretical Framework
with Ariadna Dumitrescu

A model in which firms read rival mergers as a noisy signal of a changing competitive regime and update their beliefs before adjusting R&D.

Fellowships and Scholarships

Esade PhD Scholarship	2022 – 2025
Esade MRes Scholarship	2021 – 2022

Presentations

FMA Annual Meeting, Doctoral Consortium, Tampa, FL	October 2026
EFMA Annual Meeting, Doctoral Consortium, Kristiansand, Norway	June 2026
ENGAGE.EU Conference on Impact Investing and Measurement, University of Mannheim	November 2024

Teaching

Instructor of record for more than 30 course sections at BBA and MBA level (2017–2020), all taught in English.

Lecturer in Finance 2017 – 2020
EU Business School *Barcelona, Spain*

Course	*Level*	*Period*	*Sections*
Business Finance	BBA	2017 – 2019	7
Corporate Finance	BBA	2017 – 2019	5
Cases in Finance	BBA	2017 – 2018	2
Corporate Finance	MBA	2017 – 2019	5
Advanced Finance	MBA	2017 – 2018	1
Managing Financial Resources (co-taught), University of Derby programme	BBA	2019 – 2020	

Lecturer in Finance 2017 – 2020
La Salle, Ramon Llull University *Barcelona, Spain*

Corporate Finance	BBA	2017 – 2019	3
Financial Management	BBA	2017 – 2019	2
Principles of Finance	BBA	2019 – 2020	3
Accounting Principles II	BBA	2018 – 2019	1
Entrepreneurial Finance for E-Business	BBA	2018 – 2019	1

Teaching Assistant 2023
ESADE Business School *Barcelona, Spain*

Corporate Finance *Teaching assistant for Vicente J. Bermejo, 60 hours*	MSc	Fall 2023	3
Organizational Behavior Theory *Teaching assistant for François Collet, 60 hours*	BBA	Spring 2023	3

Academic Service

Finance Subject Coordinator (first in the role) 2018 – 2020
EU Business School *Barcelona, Spain*

- Created the coordination of the finance subject area, starting with three courses and taking on more over time
- Standardized and harmonized syllabi across courses, sections and instructors
- Designed examinations with the instructors, with a version for each group built on common learning outcomes and rubrics
- Moderated grading across groups to ensure consistent and fair assessment; supervised continuous-assessment activities

Organizing support, Esade Spring Workshop, Barcelona	June 2026
Organizing support, V Workshop of the Spanish Macroeconomics Network, Esade	October 2022

Additional Training

Financial Economics of Climate and Sustainability, Harvard University, Salata Institute	Spring 2025, 2026
The Data Economy, PhD course with Isaac Baley and Laura Veldkamp	June 2025
RECSM Summer School: Machine Learning; Computational Social Media Analysis, Universitat Pompeu Fabra	July 2024
PhD Summer School on Finance and Product Markets, with Laurent Frésard and Gordon Phillips, USI Lugano	July 2023

Professional Experience

External Consultant, Line Sports & Entertainment, Barcelona	2018
Financial Analyst Intern, AddVante Group, Barcelona	2017
Cost Control Analyst Intern, CIH Bank, Casablanca	2015

Skills

Programming: Python, Stata, R, MATLAB, VBA, LaTeX
Methods: natural language processing, text analysis, transformer-based embeddings, causal inference
Data: job postings (LinkUp), Compustat, CRSP, FactSet, SDC Platinum, patent data

Languages

Arabic (native), French (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent, DELE C1)

References

Carolina Villegas-Sanchez (advisor) carolina.villegas@esade.edu
Full Professor, Department of Economics, Finance and Accounting
ESADE Business School

Ariadna Dumitrescu (advisor) ariadna.dumitrescu@esade.edu
Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Finance and Accounting
ESADE Business School

Vicente J. Bermejo vicente.bermejo@esade.edu
Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Finance and Accounting
Director, Group for Research in Economics and Finance (GREF)
ESADE Business School

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